

Clustering and Machine Learning Models (FML Module V)

Introduction to Clustering Concepts

- Definition
 - Type of Unsupervised Learning
 - Grouping similar unlabeled data objects
- Applications
 - Customer Segmentation
 - Anomaly Detection
 - Document Classification
 - Genomics
- Cluster Characteristics
 - Shape (Spherical, Arbitrary)
 - Size (Uniform or Varying)
 - Density (Tight or Loose)
 - Distance Metrics (Euclidean, Manhattan, Cosine)
- Algorithm Types
 - Partitioning Methods (K-Means, K-Medoids)
 - Hierarchical Methods (Agglomerative, Divisive)
 - Density-Based Methods (DBSCAN, OPTICS)
 - Model-Based Methods (GMM)
- Challenges
 - Determining optimal K value
 - Scalability for large datasets
 - Interpretability

K-Means Clustering

- Overview: Partitions data into K clusters
- Goal: Minimize distance to cluster centroids
- Algorithm Steps
 - 1. Initialization (Choose K random centroids)
 - 2. Assignment (To nearest centroid)
 - 3. Update (Recalculate centroid mean)
 - 4. Repeat (Until stabilization)
- Fixing the Value of K
 - Elbow Plot (WCSS curve flattening)
 - Gap Statistic Method (Compare original vs. random datasets)

Hierarchical Model

- Description: Builds cluster hierarchy (no K needed in advance)
- Types
 - Agglomerative (Bottom-Up: merges closest clusters)
 - Divisive (Top-Down: splits single cluster)
- Agglomerative Steps
 - 1. Calculate Distance Matrix
 - 2. Merge Closest Clusters
 - 3. Visualize via Dendrogram
- Dendrogram Use
 - Determining K via largest vertical distance cut
 - Useful for small to medium datasets

DBSCAN Model

- Description: Density-based algorithm
- Handles varying shapes and sizes
- Key Concepts
 - Core Point (MinPts points within ϵ radius)
 - Border Point
 - Noise Point (Outlier)
- Parameters
 - Epsilon (ϵ): Radius for neighbor search
 - MinPts: Minimum required points for dense region
- Advantages
 - Finds arbitrary shapes
 - Automatically detects outliers
 - No need to specify K
- Limitations
 - Struggles with varying densities
 - Sensitive to ϵ and MinPts choice

Spiral Model (Risk-Driven Process)

- Description: Combines iterative and waterfall elements
- Ideal for: Large, complex, high-risk projects
- Key Features
 - Iterative Cycles (Spirals)
 - Continuous Risk Management
 - Prototyping
 - Customer Feedback
- Phases in Each Spiral
 - 1. Planning Phase
 - 2. Risk Analysis Phase (Assess uncertainty)
 - 3. Engineering Phase (Design, build, test)
 - 4. Evaluation Phase (Stakeholder review)